INCH-POUND
MIL-DTL-49285/24B
31 August 2018
SUPERSEDING
MIL-DTL-49285/24A
1 March 2010

DETAIL SPECIFICATION SHEET

CABLE, SPECIAL PURPOSE, ELECTRICAL, FOUR INDIVIDUALLY SHIELDED PAIRS OF 22 (7 X 28) AWG

Inactive for new design after 16 June 1997.

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

The requirements for acquiring the product described herein shall consist of this specification sheet and MIL-DTL-49285.

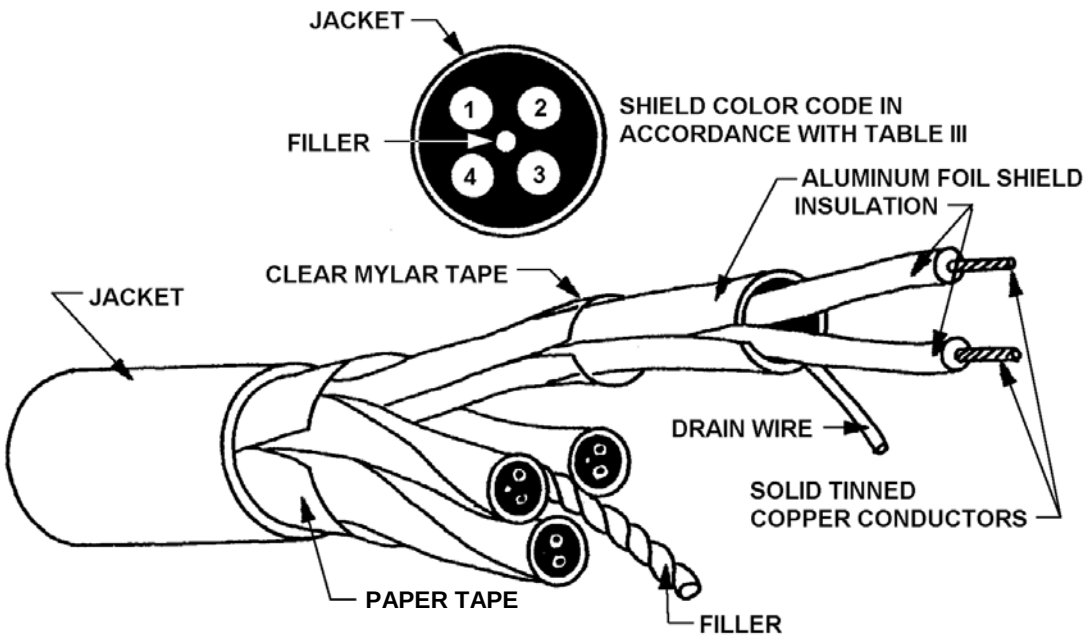


FIGURE 1. Cable illustration.

Engineering information: See table I.

Not recommended for shipboard or aerospace applications due to toxic smoke release in the event of a fire. PVC is not recommended in other applications (i.e. confined spaces, low ventilation) where there is the potential for human smoke exposure in a fire.

AMSC N/A

FSC 6145

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T19:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. Description, electrical.

Electrical characteristics	Requirements
Nominal capacitance between conductors	27 pF/ft (picofarads/foot)
Nominal capacitance between the conductor and the shield with one conductor tied to the shield	49 pF/ft
Continuous working voltage	400 V rms maximum between conductors
Nominal capacitance between adjacent shields	150 pF/ft
Continuous working voltage between adjacent shields	50 volts maximum
Shield dc resistance	14 ohms/1,000 feet maximum

TABLE II. Description, physical.

Components	Construction details
Number of conductors	Four individually shielded
Conductor type and wire size	Stranded tinned copper 20 AWG
Conductor stranding	7 X 28 AWG
Conductor insulation	Polypropylene
Conductor insulation thickness	0.015 inch nominal thickness
Drain wire type and size	Stranded tinned copper 22 AWG
Drain wire stranding	7 X 30 AWG
Jacket material	Polyvinyl chloride
Jacket thickness	0.030 inch
Finished cable diameter	0.380 inch maximum outside diameter
Cable style (UL)	Not applicable
Tensile strength (jacket)	2,000 pounds per square inch minimum
Elongation (jacket)	150 percent minimum
Overall cabling lay lengths	5.7 twists per foot $\pm$ 10 percent

Cabled pair orientation: The position of the red and green pair shield shall determine the rotation direction for pair location (see figure 1).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T19:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE III. Shield color code.

Pair numbers	Shield color
Center core	
1st pair	Red
2nd pair	Green
3rd pair	Blue
4th pair	Blue

REQUIREMENTS:

Design and construction: (see table II):

Shield location and orientation. The polyester aluminum shield is to be located on the outer circumference of the pair, with the aluminum foil side inward. Insulation on the exterior of the shield is to be complete with no aluminum available for contact.

Drain wire location. The drain wire is to be spirally located beneath the shield with the insulated conductors. It is to be in continuous contact with the aluminum surface of the foil shield throughout the cable.

Cable temperature rating. The cable temperature rating shall be -20°C to +80°C.

Flammability. The cable shall pass UL 2556 flame test requirement.

Shield integrity test.*

Frequency	Response
100 kHz	110 dB or more below reference
500 kHz	102 dB or more below reference
1 MHz	95 dB or more below reference
5 MHz	80 dB or more below reference
10 MHz	73 dB or more below reference
15 MHz	69 dB or more below reference
20 MHz	65 dB or more below reference
25 MHz	62 dB or more below reference
30 MHz	59 dB or more below reference

* Any two readings may deviate to a value of 0.9 times the stated limits.

Fixture resonance will occur between 40 and 70 MHz.

At 100 MHz: At least 47 dB below reference.

Crosstalk test limits. Crosstalk testing is not required for this configuration.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T19:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Conductor color code.

1st pair:

1st conductor: Red
2nd conductor: Black

2nd pair:

1st conductor: Green
2nd conductor: White

3rd pair:

1st conductor: White with red stripe
2nd conductor: White with black stripe

4th pair:

1st conductor: White with green stripe
2nd conductor: White with yellow stripe

Polyester tape wrap. Each shielded pair is to be covered with a plastic barrier tape.

Paper tape wrap. A paper barrier tape is to be placed between the jacket and the cabled pair.

Roundness. Fillers will be used to insure roundness.

Insulation resistance between shields: 100 megohms-1,000 feet (minimum).

Durometer hardness. The cable jacket shall have a “Shore A” hardness of 94 ± 3.

Part or Identifying Number (PIN): The PIN shall be M49285/24.

Changes from previous issue. The margins of this specification are marked with vertical lines to indicate where changes from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the previous issue.

Referenced documents. In addition to MIL-DTL-49285, this document references the following: UL 2556.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T19:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

CONCLUDING MATERIAL

Custodians:
Army – CR
Navy – SH
Air Force – 85
DLA - CC

Preparing activity:
DLA - CC

Review activities:
Army – MI
Air Force - 71
DLA – CQ

(Project 6145-2018-040)

NOTE: The activities listed above were interested in this document as of the date of this document. Since organizations and responsibilities can change. You should verify the currency of the information above using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-22T19:59Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.